

Yeoford Village Voice

Distributed free to homes in Yeoford and District, Devon

March 2026

Issue 419

YEOFORD Community Beer Festival

THE YeoFest XVI FILES

**SATURDAY
14TH MARCH**

16+ BEERS, CIDERS

HOT & COLD FOOD

**LIVE ENTERTAINMENT
& GAMES**

**£3.50 ENTRANCE
INCLUDING
SOUVENIR GLASS
& PROGRAMME**



FROM 11:30 AT YEOFORD COMMUNITY HALL

This month: Beer! Wildlife Log Books! Cider! Battery Advice! Into The Breach! Music! Chapel Lake! Games! Rugby! And much, much more...

Contact Details

THE YEOFORD VILLAGE VOICE TEAM

Editor:

Jonathan Rogers 01363 84501
yvveditor@yahoo.co.uk

Advertising:

Di Parsons 01363 84155
diparsons9876@gmail.com

Everything else:

David Lucking 01363 84988

LOCAL ORGANISATIONS

YEOFORD COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION

Chair: Carl Wholey

Bookings: yeoford.hall@gmail.com 01363 84501

YEOFORD RECREATION GROUND

Warden: David Lucking 01363 84988

CREDITON HAMLETS PARISH COUNCIL

Chairman: John Stevens 07968169274

Clerk: Charlotte Long 01363 84558
clerk@creditonhamlets-pc.gov.uk

YEOFORD PRIMARY SCHOOL

Contact: School Administrator 01363 84234

YEOFORD HOLY TRINITY CHURCH

Contact: Carol Price 01647 24468

WEST DOWN CHAPEL YEOFORD ROAD

Contacts: David Pitts djpitts270@gmail.com; 01363 773379; Derek Coren
shortacombe@googlemail.com; 01647 24264 / 07929858527

YEOFORD CRICKET CLUB

Captain: Paul Coren 01363 84238

YEOFORD 200 C£UB

Contact: club200yeoford@outlook.com

USEFUL CONTACTS

POLICE

101 in a non-Emergency
999 in an Emergency
0800 555111 Crimestoppers
0800 405040 Transport Police

EMERGENCIES

105 Electricity Failure
0845 9881188 EA Floodline
0800 807060 Environment Hotline
0800 111999 Gas Emergency
0800 1691144 Water Leaks/Burst Mains
0845 1551004 Roads/Street Lights
0310 1234999 RSPCA
0845 6000388 Social Services

MEDICAL

01363 772227 Redlands Primary Carey
01647 24272 Cheriton Bishop Surgery
111 NHS Choices (non-Emergency)
01363 775588 Crediton Hospital
01363 772062 Boots Pharmacy
01363 773030 Crediton Pharmacy
01363 772841 Lloyds Pharmacy
C159X Yeoford Defibrillator Code
No Code Required Duck Defibrillator

SCHOOLS

01363 84234 Yeoford Primary
01363 773401 QE Academy Trust

OTHERS

01363 778410 Citizens Advice
0845 7484950 National Rail Enquiries
01363 85273 The Duck at Yeoford
01363 773303 Crediton Ring and Ride

COUNCILS/MP

0345 155 1015 Devon County Council
01884 255255 Mid Devon District Council
0207 2197037 Mel Stride MP
mel.stride.mp@parliament.uk

The Village Voice Really Needs You...

The Yeoford Village Voice relies on advertising and donations to ensure that it goes to press each month. To advertise in the Village Voice and reach over 600 people locally:

Monthly Charges

Full Page...£20 Half Page...£15

Quarter...£8 Eighth...£4

Please contact **Di** on

01363 84155 [diparsons9876@gmail.com] to discuss your requirements.

Editorial

February, where did that go?

I told you it would seem like 5mins and, whoosh, it's gone. February, what's the point? Other than payday seems to come around a tad quicker. Anyway, it's still all about the rain here...nearly 3 months without a dry day, that really is something. Oh, it's just the natural cycle of long-term meteorological fluctuation you say, no it's not, although at least now we are getting some spells of sun, so maybe, just maybe things will dry out a bit.

So, what's been happening? Not an awful lot and still no sign of those 200 Club numbers, but at least Chapel Lake has been drained. This obviously caused a lot of consternation in the village as it inconvenienced many. As I mentioned last month, the responsibility is multi-faceted, but things definitely aren't helped by removing the grate, as one of our readers points out later. A duck pond would be quite nice down there mind.

Another unwelcome result of the bad weather was the continued closure of the Tarka Line, where issues up the line meant that trains couldn't run to and from Exeter to Barnstaple...they could run to and from Exeter to Copplestone, but, for whatever reason that contingency never quite gets put in place. Logistics probably. I'm being polite.

Anyway, March and that means Yeofest, which will be held on Saturday 14th up at the hall. 18 beers, 5 ciders, hot and cold food, music, games, rugby, the usual and, hopefully a large influx of people to the village, so let's hope the weather takes a turn for the better and the trains don't do anything weird.

Cheers...

The Editor

The Village Voice Is YOUR Village Magazine

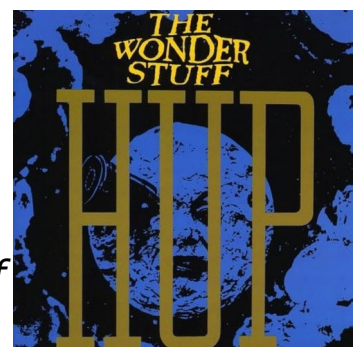
We want to hear from you and want you to use it to convey anything you feel of interest to your fellow villagers.

Please leave any items for the YVV at Torridon, Station Road before the **20th of each month**, anything after that date may not be considered until the following month. **You must provide a name and address**, even if this is not for publication.

You can also email the editor, Jonathan, at **yvveditor@yahoo.co.uk** or phone **01363 84501**

Publishing date: **the first week of each month.**

The Village Voice accepts no responsibility for any of the information or contributions contained herein.



Local Information

YEOFORD COMMUNITY HALL

COMMUNITY HALL CHARGES (hourly rate)

	Trustee User Groups	Local Community Groups	Private Bookings (Local)	Private Bookings (Non Local)
Main Hall (includes kitchen)	£3.00	£5.00	£8.00	£10.00
Meeting Room (includes kitchen)	£2.00	£3.00	£3.50	£5.50
Party/Wedding 24hr hire	—	—	£150	£250
Party/Wedding 48hr hire	—	—	£400	£500

Exclusive field use, BBQ, Stage, Disco Equipment also available.

For bookings, please e-mail yeoford.hall@gmail.com
Or phone: 01363 84501

The latest hall calendar can be found at
www.yeoford.org/community-hall

Cover Photo

Fancy getting your picture on the front of the VV? Then send your photos, drawings, musings, or whatever to yvveditor@yahoo.co.uk and there's a good shout it'll appear on the cover!

* Yeoford Community Garden *
* Yeoford Community Hall now has an area *
* dedicated to providing a small community *
* garden. Any villagers are welcome to get *
* involved in running and maintaining the *
* garden. *
* Please speak to Dee Hawkins or email *
* yeoford.hall@gmail.com for further *
* information. *

Top Tip!

Trick your neighbours into thinking you're training for the 2030 Winter Olympics GB Curling Team by sweeping your front drive dead fast whilst randomly shouting, "Woah! Woah! Hold! Hold! Curl! Curl!!!" for 2 hours...

PUNCHBOWL RECYCLING CENTRE

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MON-FRI: 09:00 - 16:30
SAT & SUN: 10:00 - 16:30

TRAINTIMES FROM YEOFORD

NB: Yeoford is a Request Stop

TO BARNSTAPLE

Mon Sat Sun
-Fri

0540
0630 0633
0725 0730
0834 0837
0937 0937 0938
1037 1037 1039
1137 1137 1138
1237 1238 1238
1337 1337 1335
1437 1438 1435
1537 1537 1536
1637 1637 1637
1738 1739 1736
1841 1844 1836
1943 1947 1938
2041 2043 2037
2147 2145

2313
Fo

TO EXETER

Mon Sat Sun
-Fri

0708 0713
0813 0816
0918 0921
1019 1018 1017
1117 1117 1117
1216 1216 1221
1319 1319 1317
1417 1417 1417
1516 1516 1519
1617 1617 1614
1719 1720 1718
1822 1825 1818
1924 1930 1917
2023 2026 2017
2124 2123 2119
2227 2224 2226
2320 2320
Fx
2352
Fo

Fx – Monday-Thursday
Fo – Friday only
For more details, go to
GWR.com/timetables



Bus Timetables

677 (Fridays only)

Dartline Coaches

Zeal Monachorum Church	0912
Coleford Gospel Hall	0927
Colebrooke Church	0932
THE DUCK AT YEOFORD	0936
YEO VIEW	0938
Raddon Down Cross	0945
Crediton TIC High Street	0955
Exeter Sidwell Street	1020

Exeter Sidwell Street	1320
Crediton TIC High Street	1345
Raddon Down Cross	1350
THE DUCK AT YEOFORD	1355
YEO VIEW	1357
Colebrooke Church	1403
Coleford Gospel Hall	1408
Zeal Monachorum Church	1423

669 (Tuesdays only)

MD Buses

South Zeal Oxenham Arms	0915
Whiddon Down Shelter	0922
Hittisleigh Cross	0930
Crockernwell	0945
Cheriton Bishop School	0947
THE DUCK AT YEOFORD	1002
Colebrooke Church	1010
Coleford Gospel Hall	1013
Crediton St Saviour's Way	1022
Crediton Morrisons	1027

Crediton Morrisons	1115
Crediton St Saviour's Way	1235
Coleford Gospel Hall	1244
Colebrooke Church	1247
THE DUCK AT YEOFORD	1255
Cheriton Bishop School	1310
Crockernwell	1313
Hittisleigh Cross	1326
Whiddon Down Shelter	1328
South Zeal Oxenham Arms	1335

YEOFORD POST OFFICE

Friday 3:15-4:15pm in the Community Hall

Free Banking available for most Banks, Personal & Business. All Post Office Services. Post Office One4All Gift Cards. Currency. Mobile, Electric & Gas Top-Ups. Dry cleaning. Cards & Stationery items.

Contact: CHUDLEIGH POST OFFICE; TEL: 01626 852149



FROM THE PARISH COUNCIL

REPORTING A PROBLEM WITH ROADS TO DEVON COUNTY COUNCIL

All drivers will be aware that state of repair of roads in Crediton Hamlets Parish is appalling, with more and more potholes (or are they craters?) appearing. The lack of action by Devon County Council is exceedingly frustrating but please report potholes in the hope this makes a difference.

Problems with roads can be reported on the Devon County Council website:
www.devon.gov.uk/roads-and-transport/report-a-problem/

There is a link to this page under "Useful Information" on the Parish Council website
www.creditonhamlets.org.uk.

If the pothole has already been reported please add yourself to the existing report so that Devon County Council is aware that another person has reported the problem.



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The coffee morning will be on Tuesday 17th March, 10.30am in the Hayloft at Mole Avon. The open meeting is on **Wednesday 18th** in the Boniface Centre, 10am, with guest speakers **Peter Knight and Alan Murray on Ley and Earth Energy lines round Crediton.** It costs £2, including refreshments, and everyone is welcome - you don't have to be a member.



Library at the Church

Following the demise of the Mobile Library, alongside the books at the station, there is also now a small library in Yeoford Church and all are welcome to borrow books.



Crediton Arts Centre News

**Spring Awakening Music Festival
March 2026**

Thursday 19 Moon Jazz

Top-notch jazz stylings from the
Moon Jazz House Band and
jammers

Friday 20 And 'Other' Stories

Turning Tides Project with live
music, spoken word and a splendid
exhibition

Sunday 22 Share in the Square

Sunday afternoon sounds from the
best of Crediton's musical talent
Sunday 22 Drumming Workshop
Devon Drummers return with an
energetic participatory workshop

**Monday 23 Spinal Tap II: The End
Continues**

The long-awaited sequel, a fitting
tribute to the late Rob Reiner

**Tuesday 24 Crediton Strummers
Workshop**

Popular songs given the treatment
by Ed Finch and his musical
renegades

25 March Acoustic by Candlelight

The lovely St Lawrence Chapel is
the setting for more acoustic
delights

26 March Rose

Tom Harper's award-winning film
starring Jessie Buckley

27 March Filkin's Drift

Rising Stars of the folk circuit with
dazzling instrumental fireworks

**28 March Kathryn Roberts & Sean
Lakeman**

Legendary multi award-winning duo,
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Church.

Check the website for more details
www.creditonartscentre.org

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Parish Voluntary Wildlife Warden

Rain, relentless rain. Wild storms and flooding occurring all along the Atlantic seaboard, as far down as Morocco. Lives lost, property and roads destroyed. I have to wonder, is this climate change?

January was the wettest since 1968 at Winkleigh weather station. The River Yeo came within 3cm of its highest recorded level in 1996.

2022, 2023 and 2025 are the 3 warmest years on record in the UK. Warm air carries more water and creates bigger storms. It seems likely that our new extreme weather patterns are being driven by climate change and could get worse.

What does this mean for wildlife?

Riverbanks have been lost. Homes for bank voles kingfishers and otters may have been lost. We can but hope the occupants escaped.

Hibernating hedgehogs and snakes may too have been flooded and would probably not wake up in time.

Buzzards, hawks and owls hours of hunting have been really restricted by the rain. Some may well not survive.

Yet not all is gloom. I've seen large flocks of starlings and goldfinches. My garden birds are at pre-winter levels. Trees have taken a beating but not fallen and spring growth is clear to see.

The goldfinches here on Shortacombe Lane have benefitted greatly from the planting of 2 sunflower fields by the Corens last year for gamebird cover. Here's hoping this happens again this year and that other farmers follow.

And finally the Wildlife Log Books have arrived and will be waiting for you to record your observations at The Duck and Holy Trinity Church in Yeoford.

Any observations are welcome not just the rare. To help build a clearer picture of our wild residents and visitors.

Next month I hope I can be out walking and writing about it again.

Anna (artonmove@hotmail.com)



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JOKE OF THE MONTH COMPETITION

I got a book at the charity shop titled 'A Guide to surgical Procedures'. I opened it up and the appendix was missing.

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YEOFORD COMMUNITY ASSOCIATION

would like to thank the following companies and individuals for their continual support...

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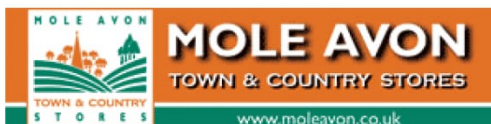


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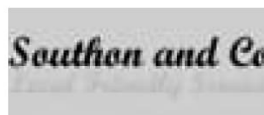


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February 2026



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STRATFORD HERALD



**TEDBURN ST MARY VILLAGE HALL
SAT 14 MAR 2026 7.30PM**

CREDITON ROAD TEDBURN ST MARY EX6 6DZ

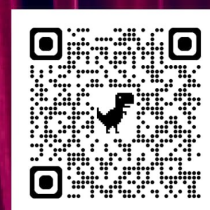
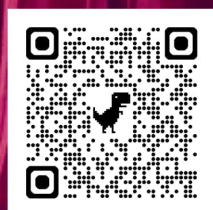
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YEOFORD VILLAGE VOICE FUN QUIZ

Well, it's March, and in Yeoford, that means it's Yeofest, so let's have a beer quiz...

1. Oktoberfest is held in which month in Munich?
2. Within how many days is it recommended cask ale should be sold within once put on sale?
3. Which is the biggest beer drinking nation in the world? (Volume per capita)
4. Which country in the world produces the most beer by volume?
5. What is the UK's current top-selling cask ale, according to Morning Advertiser Drink List, recently overtaking Sharp's Doom Bar?
6. Where and when was beer supposedly accidentally invented?
7. What is the name of the low-alcohol combination of beer and fruit-flavoured sodas, originating in Germany in the 1920s and similar to shandy, that is becoming increasingly popular across Europe...and what does the name mean?
8. Approximately how many pints of beer will be available at Yeofest this year (clue: there's 18 barrels)?
9. What is the name of the device attached to beer pumps, predominately used up north, that controls the texture of the beer and produces a creamy head, but can also mask a beer's poor condition and cause the beer to go flat faster?
10. What is the current CAMRA Champion Beer of Britain (which has appeared at two previous Yeofests)?

Answers below...

Quiz Answers:

1. September; 2. 3 days; Czechia; 4. China; 5. Timothy Taylor's Landlord; 6. Beer was not invented by one specific person, but rather discovered by chance in ancient Mesopotamia (modern-day Iraq) around 6,000-8,000 BC; 7. Radler, which translates to cyclist; 8. 1,296; 9. A sparkler; 10. Penzance Mild



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Yeoford Community Hall has availability for community groups for one-offs or regular bookings on Wednesday evenings, Thursday evenings or Sunday evenings. Exercise classes, craft groups, workshops, educational events or social clubs would be warmly welcomed. Trial periods will be accommodated.

Daytime slots on occasional Tuesdays and Thursdays are also available.

West Down Chapel Yeoford Road

Sunday March 1st Morning Worship at 11am with Paul Squares

Tuesday 3rd Ladies Bible Study at Venbridge House at 10.30am plus Tea/ Coffee and cake

Sunday 8th Morning Worship at 11am with John Allan

Wednesday 11th Friends and Neighbours at 2pm come and join us, Tea/Coffee and biscuits

Sunday 15th Morning Worship at 11am with Rev John Passmore

Tuesday 17th Ladies Bible Study at Venbridge House at 10.30am plus Tea/ Coffee and cake

Sunday 22nd Morning Worship at 11am with Peter Boddington

Sunday 22nd Lunch following the Morning Service to book phone Kate 07772 239419. After lunch its prayer fellowship 2-3pm

Sunday 29th Morning Worship at 11am with Ben Hoben

Tuesday 31st Ladies Bible Study at Venbride House at 10.30am plus Tea/ Coffee and cake

Holy Trinity Church Yeoford

Services are a bit different this month because our Family Service is on Mothering Sunday instead of the 4th Sunday. We would love to see many of you there.

Café Company Mondays from 10 till 11am except when there is Lunch Club.

Community Lunch March 2nd
12:15 for 12:30.

Services for March

Sunday 8th March

Holy Communion 9:30am

Sunday 15th Mothering Sunday

Family Service 11:15am

Come and make a gift for Mum

Coffee and cake from 11am

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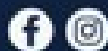
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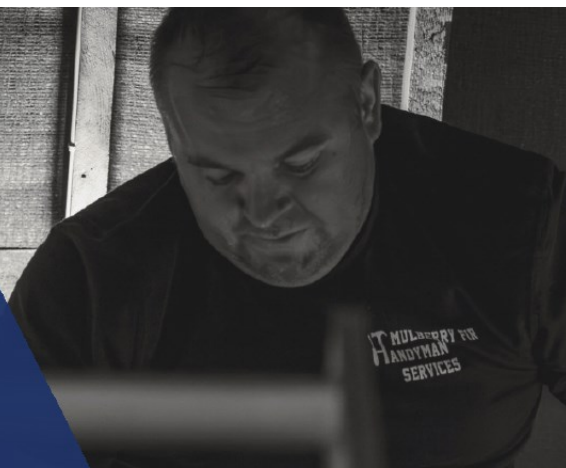
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CREDITON HAMLETS PARISH COUNCIL

Following the recent appalling weather it was unsurprising that flooding, drainage overspill, gritting and potholes dominated discussion at the February meeting. In conclusion Cllr Cairney (DCC) undertook to take up the issues raised by Councillors with Head of DCC Highways.

MDDC Councillors notified the meeting of the following events:

- 26 March - Town and Planning Event - 6.00pm to 8.30pm to be held on-line.
- Green Enterprise Grants will be starting from March.
- March MDDC meeting will disclose the on-going planning policy with particular reference to Government housing objectives.

DISPOSAL OF BATTERIES

As a result of fires caused by batteries being put into recycling/wheelie bins MDDC have stipulated that:

BATTERIES (OF ANY SIZE EVEN THE LITTLE ONES) SHOULD NOT BE PLACED IN RECYCLING BOXES OR WASTE WHEELIE-BINS.

INSTEAD:

BATTERY TERMINALS SHOULD BE COVERED IN MASKING TAPE AND THEN BATTERIES SHOULD BE PUT INTO SEALED PLASTIC BAGS AND PLACED ADJACENT BUT OUTSIDE RE-CYCLING BOXES.

PLEASE READ: AIR AMBULANCE

An appeal to all our villagers

If you, your children or anyone you know plays in the recreation ground please always check with them that they have returned the goals to the edge of the field.

This is because the Air Ambulance **CANNOT LAND** if the goals are in the middle of the field.

If you pass the recreation ground or see anybody playing with the goals in the centre, could you please remind them (politely) that they should be returned to the edge after use, or move them back if you find them abandoned like this.

Thank you all for your cooperation.

Yeoford Community Association

Opening times - Monday CLOSED
Tuesday CLOSED
Wednesday CLOSED
Thursday 11.30am - 10.00pm
Friday 11.30am - 10.30pm
Saturday 11.30am - 10.30pm
Sunday 11.30am - 5.30pm

As always, the Pub-Up Shop is open when the pub is open. We continue to offer takeaways each night and Sunday lunch.

Details of these can be found on the website, on our Facebook page, on the Yeoford Hub and on our Instagram page.

If in doubt, please call us.

Looking forward to April we will be closed from 6th - 19th April inclusive.

James, Sarah, Zachary, Lydia and Martha

01363 85273
theduckatyeoford.co.uk



A Villager Writes...

Stupid Behaviour concerning removing Drain Covers

To the Person that removed the drain cover at Chapel immediately below the Flood Marker Board you have made our situation on the road to Hittisleigh impossible.

For years myself and other kind locals have removed debris successfully without any need to lift covers.

This is the reason we are still massively inconvenienced by your meddling.

Highways should have put signs on North Down Cross to say Road Closed due to Flooding and Station Cross but after reporting that requirement on Monday 2/2/26 I have now witnessed a school service bus reverse near a mile from the flood to North Down where it could turn successfully to go another way, I spent 20 minutes waiting on the Highway number to raise this issue again today Wednesday 4/2/26.

Whoever you are Do Not Do it Again.

Name and address supplied

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more comfortable.**

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have my time over
again, I would
have had them
fitted earlier.”**

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